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PR Writing

Quotes Journalists Actually Use

And the ones they cut



Raise It With Press Release

swipe →

01

The "Thrilled" Test

If the quote would fit any company's release, it fits none. Delete "thrilled", "proud", "excited" and see what's left.

example

× "We are thrilled to launch our new app."
✓ "Half our orders come after 9PM. The app is built for people who shop after their shift."

02

Give an Opinion, Not a Summary

The body of the release covers the facts. The quote is where a human explains **why it matters** or **what happens next**.

03

One Number, Said Like a Person

Numbers make quotes quotable, but read them out loud first. If it sounds like a spreadsheet, rewrite it.

example

× "Revenue increased by 37.42% YoY."
✓ "We grew by more than a third this year, mostly outside Metro Manila."

04

Keep It Under 40 Words

Reporters trim long quotes or skip them. Two sentences: the point, then the reason.

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72%

of journalists call press releases the most useful PR resource

A quote that can be lifted word for word is part of what makes a release usable.

Source: Cision, State of the Media 2025

Quote Checklist

- [x] No "thrilled / proud / excited"
- [x] States a view or what happens next
- [x] At most one number, said naturally
- [x] Under 40 words, two sentences
- [x] Approved by the person named

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Write It Like They'll Quote It

1. Save this checklist
2. Send it to whoever drafts your CEO quotes

Source:
· Cision, State of the Media 2025